

Mad Scientist Explorations – Metallicman

 metallicman.com/laoban4site/mad-scientist-explorations

congjing yu

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Now what do you suppose this Mad Scientist is up to? Image [source](#).

As a young boy, I dreamed of being a “Mad Scientist”. At that time my imagination was fueled by [Vincent Price](#) movies, the gadgets of “[The Man from U.N.C.L.E.](#)”, and of course the reading of “[The Mad Scientist Club](#)”. Later, as I grew older, I actually had opportunities to work in laboratories, work in top-secret facilities, and design and cobble together all kinds of curious and interesting gadgets. I think that it is a yearning of most boys to build, create and utilize inventions. Let’s take a look at this underappreciated need...

Vincent Price and His Movies

To people today, the name [Vincent Price](#) is meaningless. However, to children of the 60’s and the 70’s the name had meaning. For these were the movies that played during [lazy Saturday afternoons](#), and during [late night scare-fests](#). Vincent Price was more than just an actor, he was a legend. He, in some ways, defined a generation of children. He introduced us to monsters. He introduced us to the evils of man. He introduced us to ideas and concepts that were not taught to us in school. He introduced us to [B-grade movies](#) and the “Mad Scientists” the inhabited them.

"The Professor is working on something, and won't tell anyone what it is. He's got a secretary with the kind of attitude that makes it seem she was weaned on a pickle, and who looks a bit like a gene-spliced offspring of an elderly Betty Davis and Vivian Vance. To make this comparison more apt, her character is called "Ethel." To make things even more spooky, the actress' real name is "Viv!" "

- [SATURDAY AFTERNOON B-MOVIE CRAPFEST](#): *"The Phantom From 10,000 Leagues" (1955)*

This actor was quite a significant player in my boyhood. His movies, aside from "[The Abominable Dr. Phibes](#)" and "[Dr. Phibes Rises Again](#)" were just typical horror / Science Fiction flicks. (Maybe it's because I had crush(es) on his [amazing assistants](#).) The movies were easy on the eyes, and fun for a ten-year-old boy to watch.



One of my favorite Vincent Price movies was the Dr. Phibes series. Here he is with one of his pretty assistants.

It wasn't only Vincent Price who participated in those movies. There were many other actors, yet they all shared a basic similarity. The laboratories were all seemingly set in basements, often with hidden or heavily bolted doors. Behind those doors were often evil experiments. One movie might have evil Hitler Nazi's being woke up from cryogenic sleep, while another might have brain transplants. Some were involved in the reanimation of the

dead, while others involved the creation of strange huge machines that would revolutionize or destroy the world.

Indeed, the role of Nazi's in these movies was quite significant. For instance, you have [*King of the Zombies*](#) where zombies are used to conduct Nazi operations against the United States. There is [*The Frozen Dead*](#) where a scientist reanimates frozen heads of Nazi war criminals to revive Third Reich. There is [*They Saved Hitler's Brain*](#) where Nazis in South America kidnap scientist to maintain living head of Adolf Hitler in order to revive the Third Reich. In [*Shock Waves*](#) we have an Island-shipwrecked party who encounters former SS commander leading zombie storm troopers. Yikes!

This theme continued with [*The Boys from Brazil*](#) where a Nazi hunter discovers doctor's plot to revive Third Reich by cloning Hitler in Paraguayan jungle. [*Death Ship*](#) where a Nazi prison ship sails the seas since end of war luring unsuspecting victims aboard. Not willing to give up on this theme, we also have such movies as [*The Keep*](#). Where the German Army and "Einsatzkommandos" occupy Romanian citadel with demonic forces.



There were two Dr. Phibes movies. Each one used a different assistant. I was in love with both. Yikes!
Image credit to Metro Goldwyn Mayer for their promotional photo.

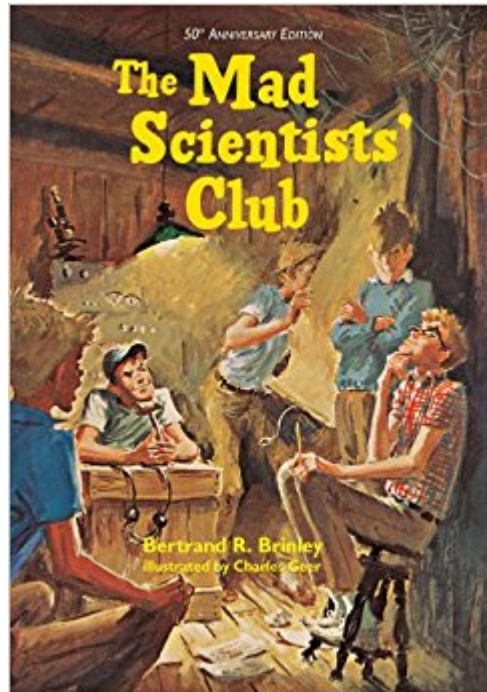
The underground lairs always involved some kind of nefarious laboratory. Inside there were always these big clunky switches that took your entire hand to pull down or push up to engage. In the dark corners of the lab were always these arc generators with bolts of electricity shooting through the air. (I believe it was there to keep the air nicely ionized for personal health and longevity.) There were always counters full of glass vials, beakers, and glassware filled with colorful liquids percolating away over lit [Bunsen burners](#).

These movies were inspirational in that they led a boy, such as myself, to believe that a single lone individual with a dream can make it happen. Oh sure they were portrayed as villains. However, I am quite sure that the reason was because they just weren't very well understood. You know, each and every one had a reason, which in their mind was just and good. All that you need to do is learn science. Study hard. Focus on your dream and apply yourself.

All you need is a dream, and to study and apply yourself to make that dream happen.

The Mad Scientist Club

The Mad Scientist Club is a series of stories (and books) written in the 1960's which fueled the imagination and adventures of us children in the 1970's. (The son of the author has a website. You can visit the website [HERE](#).) These stories inspired me. They inspired my dreams and led me down the path towards technical excellence.



The cover from the first book of "The Mad Scientists Club". This is a classic book for all young children entering their early teens.

The boys in the stories used science to create all sorts of pandemonium and mayhem in their little town. They applied themselves to using science to make devices and gadgets. They played pranks. The books showed how a boy could engineer a device from techniques that they learned in school. They made balloons, talked on ham radios, devised electronics, and they did it all on their very own.

The beauty about all this was that they never asked for help or permission. They took the initiative and did it on their own. They applied themselves.

Indeed, these stories are special. But, don't take it from me. Read what others have to say.

"This is the best kids book ever.

... In a way it saddens me when I re-read it. I don't think our kids today have as much freedom as these did (or my generation). I remember staying out until dark, riding my bike EVERYWHERE, clubhouses on vacant lots...Or maybe it's responsibility. Kids today have freedom but little responsibility. I'm getting off my soapbox now. but this is a cool book and it will make your kids fall in love with science. I imagine the Mythbusters grew up like this- or maybe their dads did!! "

-[Holly](#) commentary on the book. Found at [Goodreads](#).

I am afraid that Holly is correct. American children (and adults) don't have as much freedom as we all used to. (It's our fault, you know.) These books are for kids and inspires them to accomplish things through study and action. These books are not about getting a group together and finding a group consensus. It's not about how to cautiously speak so as not to offend anyone. Nope. It is about getting things done and raising hell in the process.

It's books like these that inspired many of us to study science and engineering. It certainly affected me. It also affected others. I am not the only one who studied about rockets and space...

"This was simply a great childhood book for any inquisitive kid who likes science, haunted houses, dinosaurs, flying machines, etc. I read this book in about seventh or eighth grade and actually a couple of times since. I believe this book helped me on my career to being a rocket scientist but it also gave me many ideas as I was growing up.

Brinley managed to capture the perfect mid-west US town and the guys in the book were great caricatures of fun loving, science minded boys with a bit of good natured mischief up their sleeves. Then Brinley took this setting and boys and produced a series of wonderful stories capturing so many things that so many boys growing up find so intriguing.

I bought a copy recently for a nephew and he was enraptured by it. The follow-ups while good never really reached the level of this first book but were fun in their own right. It will always hold a special memory of growing up back in the '60s."

-[Robert](#) commentary on the book. Found at [Goodreads](#).

He's right you know. The stories certainly inspired me.

I like to think that there is inspiration in stories where you find adventure, freedom and independence. These are things that are absolutely missing in the modern realm of politically correct stories. Which, by the way, is a very important point. By following a "Politically Correct" narrative, you retard the growth of young boys. To paraphrase [Clint Eastwood](#), you turn men into pussies.

"We live in more of a pussy generation now, where everybody's become used to saying, "Well, how do we handle it psychologically?" In those days, you just punched the bully back and duked it out. Even if the guy was older and could push you around, at least you were respected for fighting back, and you'd be left alone from then on."

-[Clint Eastwood](#)

A parent has a responsibility to PREPARE their children to venture out and grow. They need to go forth and carve a life out of the wilderness. But that is not what is happening today. Instead we have children that never leave the nest. Young men, in the United States, live

at home until they are in their 30's. Instead of investing their time in building, workings, making, and creating, they are too busy looking at cat videos on the Internet while they post their latest latté on Facebook. Boys must be taught to aspire to be Men, not to be a woman's version of a *sensitive* man.

Pussies.

No amount of tattoos, unique hair or beard, or cool urban clothing style is going to make you into a Man. It comes from within. Education alone won't do it. Money and wealth won't do it. Polite conversation won't do it. It comes from inside. It comes from deep down inside. It comes from a place that says "you can, and must do what you need to do". You don't ask for permission, or consensus. You go out and carve your life out. Alone.

By clutching on to your children like over protective mothers, the children don't grow up. Physically they might age, but the brain and the emotions are still that of a young child. How else can you explain the SWJ mentality that demands a protective overseer? Which is what they want, you know. They demand to be coddled and taken care of by a big parental government [Bernie Sanders style](#). Because, that is all that they know. They don't know how to be independent. We don't teach that anymore.

These books break us out of that mold...

"A gem. Almost unknown; but one of the most hilarious and memorable laugh-out-loud books you could ask for. It's never mentioned by anyone; it's never recommended, placed on book lists or chosen by reading-groups. This just might be because it's a series of books, which represents a 'philosophy-of-parenting', which has fallen out of favor. That's my suspicion, anyway.

I mean, just think about it. These stories are about kids who are unmonitored; who are allowed to just go off on summer afternoons and hang out on their own; and do whatever they want.... because they are trusted by their folks. Today, this is the last thing parents want to hear. No one in today's control-freak, micro-managing America wants to imagine that children can be trusted like this.

Books for very young children ('Little Prince' or 'Giving Tree') are in abundance on Goodreads. They're sweet and harmless. There's also a new genre called 'YA' ('young adult'). But guess what? They're all very sanitary, careful, cautious, and timid. Antiseptic. Content-supervised and Content-controlled. They always instruct youngsters on the 'correct' thing to do, the 'sensitive' thing to do, the 'courteous' thing to do...blah blah blah.

'Mad Scientists' is different. Instead of caution, the author praises problem-solving, solidarity, daring, and initiative. It's a book written for kids illustrating how NOT to follow the rules. It's a book, which shows that rules are made to be flouted.

These stories are from a time when today's endless complexities and anxieties just weren't around. It's a book that deals with kids just... having fun. I say, there need to be a LOT MORE books like this.

The gang of boys in Brinley's tales are pre-teens; somewhere between 11 and 14. This is a strange interval in a boy's matriculation, when they need to figure out a lot of things about life (and it's also a time when adults have the least relevant advice to offer). This is the space Brinley plays in: the theme of personal responsibility.

Teens NEED to create a few genuine catastrophes in order to learn the weight of 'cause' vs 'effect'. 'Intention' vs 'outcome'. 'Actions' vs 'harm'. They need to learn the ins-and-outs of friendship and loyalty and paying-one's-dues.

The 'Mad Scientists Club' (this is the name carved on their clubhouse door) demonstrate these themes grandly. These young scamps are precisely in that age where you learn how to make a mess and how you clean it up afterwards. By yourself!

The crazy scenarios which afflict these affable 'troublemakers' reminds us--should remind everyone-- that this process can be fun. Making mistakes and learning from them. The best way --nay, the ONLY way--to shape character.

Far cry from today, huh? Yeah. Today, we don't let kids have 'secret clubs', 'hideouts', codewords, or 'mysterious friends'. We don't let them play with equipment or tools. They must not 'wreck' anything of ours. They're certainly not allowed to 'gallivant all over creation' (love that phrase).

Modern parents are rule-mongers and control freaks. When our kids want to play, we take them to 'Sesame Place' and we monitor their nutrition and we deck them in flashing sneakers and put them in helmets and on leashes. We place them in soccer, swim class, softball, karate, dance, gymnastics.

The result? Modern kids have no idea what real 'freedom' means. We never give it to them. They turn out to be vegetables.

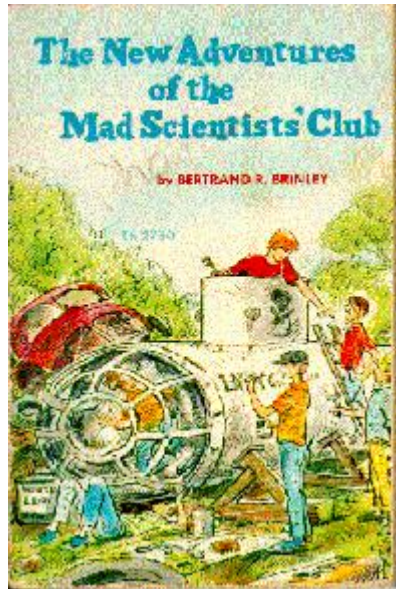
But Brinley's kids show the other way it can be done. This boy's club makes their own fun. They don't 'ask for permission' to do stuff--they just do it! They embrace wildness, zaniness, and unpredictability. The outcome? Well, they aren't brought up on charges from the Department of Homeland Security, for the trouble they cause. That's for sure. This is a part of small town-Americana we've let slip away.

Just one example: in one of the adventures undertaken by the Mad Scientists, they build their own hot-air balloon (using scraps from a local junkyard) and they enter it in the town's annual homemade hot-air balloon race. With no adult supervision at all. Once aloft, (!!) they engaged in an air-battle with their arch-foes and fire potato-cannons and slingshots back'n'forth in mid-air. Finally, they manage to send the enemy gang's balloon into the lake! Can you stand it? I can't friggin' stand it, can you?

This book reminds us that children used to be perfectly capable of taking care of themselves if we let them...if we weren't all scared out of our wits by molesters and semi-automatic weapons and drugs and porn and stalkers and computers, we'd still remember the kind of America found in this hilarious read. It's to our shame that we can't."

-[Feliks](#) commentary on the book. Found at [Goodreads](#).

Let me simply posit this; to all those men (not to intentionally exclude women, but I am a man addressing myself to other men) who have made something of their life. Maybe you are a barber, a motorcycle mechanic, a car salesman, or a cook, isn't it true? To make it in this world, you need to stretch your neck out. You need to take risks, bend the rules a little. You need to apply yourself.



The cover to the book "The New Adventures of the Mad Scientist Club". This is the sequel to the first book. It is also good, though personally, I really prefer the first book overall.

Those times when life got tough, did you go and get permission? Did you go and ask for consensus? Did you politely ask for others opinions, or did you just go out and do whatever it took to achieve your goals? Was it easy? Nope, I'll wager that it was hard, or at least uncomfortable. You might have to make sacrifices. Right? Right???

Part of the need to accomplish these tasks were goals. These goals were like this golden orb that lay there, just out of reach that you needed to obtain. You would work towards those goals. You would keep those goals in mind while you fought and persevered. A goal might be a car. A goal might be the love of your life.

A man is nothing without a goal.

A goal might be something more honorable and important, like saving the world. As everyone can't be an evil villain like George Soros. Or, a wealthy trillionaire like Bill Gates. Someone needs to wear the mask of a hero...

Speaking of heroes...

The Man from U.N.C.L.E.

In the 1960's, most Americans were worried about the "Red menace"; Communism. Yikes!

Here, in pockets around the globe, progressive socialists had gotten control of various governments and were implementing progressive social "utopias". This included the Soviet Union, "Red" China, Northern Vietnam, Cambodia, North Korea, and other socialist paradises.

In these utopias, everyone lived in a progressive liberal society.

In these nations, in these societies, everyone was equal. There wasn't any racism. Everyone knows what they can speak about and what they [dare not say](#). Everyone wore [approved clothing](#) so not to offend anyone. Everyone conformed to society for the good of all. All they had to do was give all their possessions, body and soul to the all-powerful central government...

...and the citizens were quite miserable as a result.

Ah, but that didn't stop them from expansion. They were out to take your (American) freedom away, don't ya know. They sent out spies, and agents of destruction. As a result, we had to set up spy networks to counter their spy networks. We had to be ever vigilant against the evil of liberal progressive socialism. This meant a network of trained and motivated experts.

Enter "The Man from Uncle" where a special force of well-trained agents went to fight the roots of the evils that manipulated governments. Because, while we were all busy fighting the "Red Menace", the true evils laid hidden, for they were the REAL levers of control behind the scenes.

Here, the secret agency (named U.N.C.L.E.) went to fight a very sinister agency that was set on destroying the global world order (named T.H.R.U.S.H.). In many ways it is sort of a cross between the Clinton's financial network and the George Soros organizations.



The Man from Uncle was a television show that united the cold war foes into an organization that would fight the “Deep State”. For it was recognized then, as well as now, that the “Deep State” was the source of all the ills that befell Mankind.

Against this backdrop were groups of evil villains. For, after all, there are more powerful people than well-established individual nations.

These villains would form their own networks of confederates and together they would implement all kinds of mischievous and dangerous activities. Movies and shows about this emerging phenomenon were everywhere in the 60’s. We have secret agent [James Bond](#) fighting all kinds of evil doers like [Doctor No](#).

Evil has no borders, and calls no nation home.

We had agent [Flint](#) [saving the world](#) from militant feminists who were hell bent on depose the ruling American patriarchy with a feminist matriarchy. Ah, Mr. Flint. There were others, of course. We had [Alec Leamas](#), [Joe Turner](#) and [Harry Palmer](#).

We also had television shows like “[Get Smart](#)”, “[I Spy](#)”, “[Mission Impossible](#)” and “[The Man from U.N.C.L.E.](#)” as they battled [T.H.R.U.S.H.](#)

As a boy I would watch The Man from U.N.C.L.E. with my father. He would sit there with his wine and cheese wedges, and I would eat my potato chips while we watched television

together. For me the shows were all black and white, but that was because at the time our television was a black and white TV set.

My father liked the main character, [Napoleon Solo](#) while I preferred his Russian counterpart [Illya Kuryakin](#) which reminded me of the singing group “The Beatles” who were quite popular at the time. We would watch them operate in secret, while fighting the equally secret evil organization T.H.R.U.S.H.. Of course, they had all these secret codes, [interesting devices](#), [gadgets](#) and inventions. As a boy, I was quite enraptured by them. I would imagine what it would be like if I too were a secret agent, using these contrivances and fighting evil to save the world.

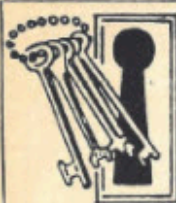
What better thing for a young boy to aspire towards?

Prank Central

However, as exciting as it all looked, my attention was elsewhere. For I was young, and boys like being mischievous and playing tricks. It’s a boy thing I suppose. (I just don’t remember any girls doing these types of things. Though, I am quite sure that they were involved in more cerebral activities playing “head games” with other girls.) Boys like to see the physical results of their torment. They want to see girls react in horror to a toad. They want to light firecrackers outside people’s bedrooms, and set bags of dog poo on fire on people’s porches.

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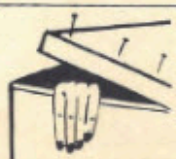
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When I was growing up, we would find these types and kinds of advertisements inside of our comic books and magazines. They would be full of all kinds of fun things to amuse a young child.

I remember as a boy how we had somehow come across a gadget catalog that was advertised in the back of one of the comic books that we would often read. You know the kind. Pages and pages of things like magic tricks, pranks, books on Black Magic, fake (pellet shooting) fingers, trick buzzers, masks and "[pea shooters](#)". As a kid, we loved it and wanted everything. We must have circled over a hundred items in that catalog.

I think that it is an interest of growing children to expand and explore these tricks and devices of prankster humor. Too bad that the days of yodeling pickles are long gone.

Indeed, you need to leave the ultra-sanitized United States to find some [politically incorrect playthings](#) for your child to enjoy.

...Or, do you?

Let me introduce the reader to the [Archie McPhee](#) store.

This is the kind of place that is a young boy's wet dream. Inside the store (physical as well as the Internet version) are absolutely enormous assortments of useless pursuits. They've got boxing nuns and bacon scarves. They've got yodeling pickles and finger hands. Don't know what a finger hand is, well then go [HERE](#) to find out. They have stuff that only a madman could think of.

| "Less talk. More monkey."

How about [rotisserie chicken flavored candy canes](#), [emergency inflatable toast](#) (why?), rubber chickens (big and [small](#)), and propeller beanies. Ah we all wanted one of these as a kid. They have trick gum, [Holy toast](#), and bags of busted businessmen. They carry x-ray glasses (yes, you wanted these didn't you?) and hypno-glasses, [wind-up lederhosen](#), and strange action figures to include [horrificed movie victims](#). They've got everything from plastic arks, to singing fish. It's a childhood delight. This store brings out the little kid in all of us. It's many things, but above all, it's the go-to place for plastic poop.

I just can't stop! It's such an amazing place.

"If there's a heaven for the deranged, Archie McPhee is probably it."

-[Josh B in Seattle](#)

How about [vinderhosen](#), an [emergency Santa kit](#), [crime scene sandwich bags](#), and classic disguises. What about underwear for your pet squirrel, [inflatable turkey](#) (again, why?), and contemporaneous prayer cards. Here is probably the only place where you can find cool World War II [occupation money](#). How about medical posters from India, they've got religious themes, [cat themes](#), food themes, mad scientist themes, and [themes that defy description](#). I am not at all kidding!



There is a store in Seattle. The rest of us are limited to visiting their (most comprehensive) website.

Do yourself a favor. Let your child buy something from this store. Give them ten dollars to spend, and wait while they go back and forth, back and forth deciding what to buy. It's all in good fun.

Build your Own Gadgets

When the children are old enough, or for you adults that just never grew up (like me, heh heh) there are outlets for obtaining the tools and supplies to build your very own mad scientist lair. Over the years I have bought from these various outlets and cobbled up some pretty interesting gadgets. In the past I have made such things as television bicycles, remote control automobile deactivators, electronic snooping equipment detector, remote control devices for insects, and all kinds of household appliances.

Here are some of my favorites;

[McMaster-Carr](#)

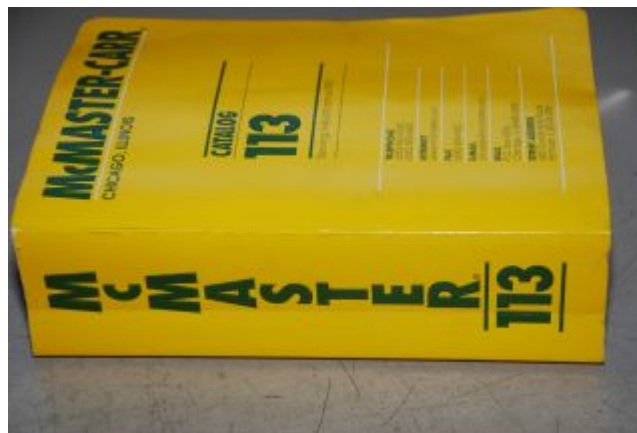
If there was ever a catalog for inventors it is this. It has everything from hardware to materials (that can be bought in small quantities). To use these parts, you will need to have an idea of what you want to build. Then you go through the catalog to find parts or components that you can use. It is wonderfully, and functionally illustrated. Additionally, most of the parts have PDF drawings, and CAD drawings that you can export to your CAD system and made up on the computer. I, of course, highly recommend it.

"The best way to describe McMaster is to say that they carry everything you need to build anything. Items that you could normally only order through factory distributors, or materials that could only be ordered in large quantities, are easily available in any size and quantity, no matter how small. (No minimum order, either!) Their prices are excellent and they tend to only carry good merchandise."

Amazingly, when I order stuff at 5:30 p.m., it arrives the next morning with their normal shipping. Their catalog has long been difficult to get because you had to be a reasonably sized business with a Dun and Bradstreet number and established credit to have them mail it to you. But now that they have added an online service, everyone can easily order from them with a credit card."

– [Alexander Rose](#)

As a point of curious interest, they used to have a large thick catalog in a bright yellow cover. I used to keep an old catalog, I think it was #93, in my bathroom and would spend my time looking through all the cool stuff while I was on the throne attending to my needs. As I stated previously, this is the go-to-first catalog for emerging Mad Scientists.

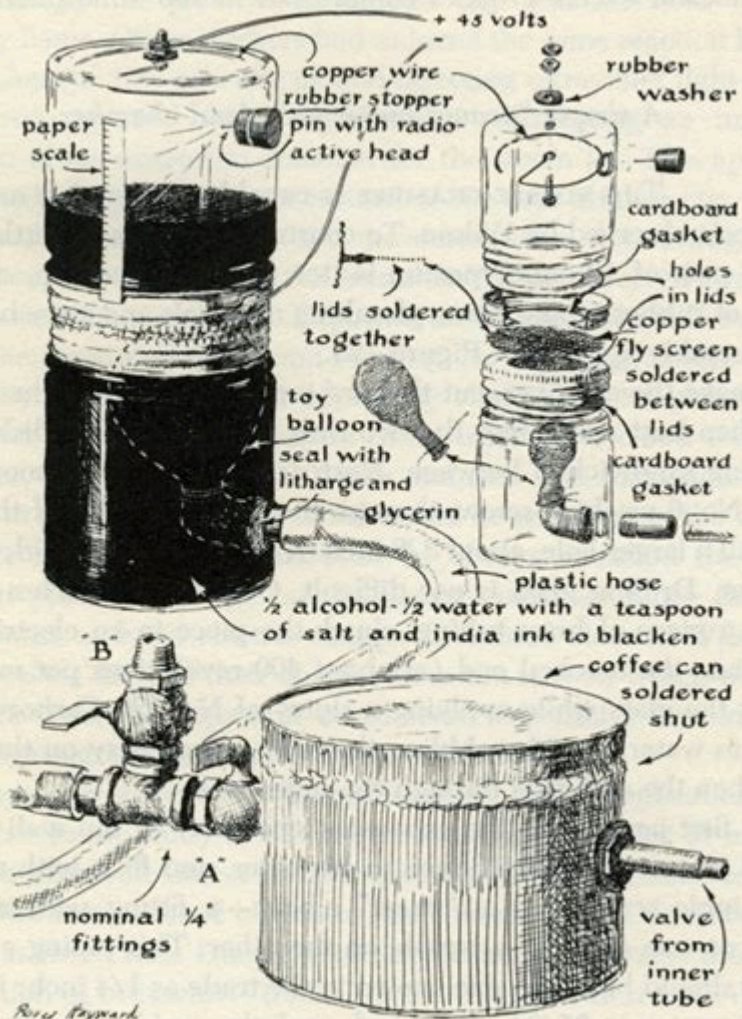


If you have an idea, a concept, a gizmo that you want to build; well Mc Master is your first stop. It is where I go to get the parts I need to cobble together designs and make specialized parts.

Science Hobbyist

When I was a boy, I used to read the Scientific American magazine. In the 1960's the magazine was appropriate for most people, including myself, interested in science. (Then during the 70's and 80's they just became another mouthpiece for the professional elite in [the ivory towers](#) in universities. The articles became too specialized and dry for casual reading.)

Anyways, back in the 1960's the magazine had a section titled "[The Amateur Scientist](#)" which was a wonderfully illustrated section describing how a hobbyist can make their own gizmos and gadgets to explore scientific principles with. This website is sort of the modern day equivalent.



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Details of Wilson cloud chamber made from two peanut-butter jars

Here is a sample page from the section in Scientific American titled "The Amateur Scientist". Just by reading the articles I believed that I too could make my own scientific experiments and inventions.

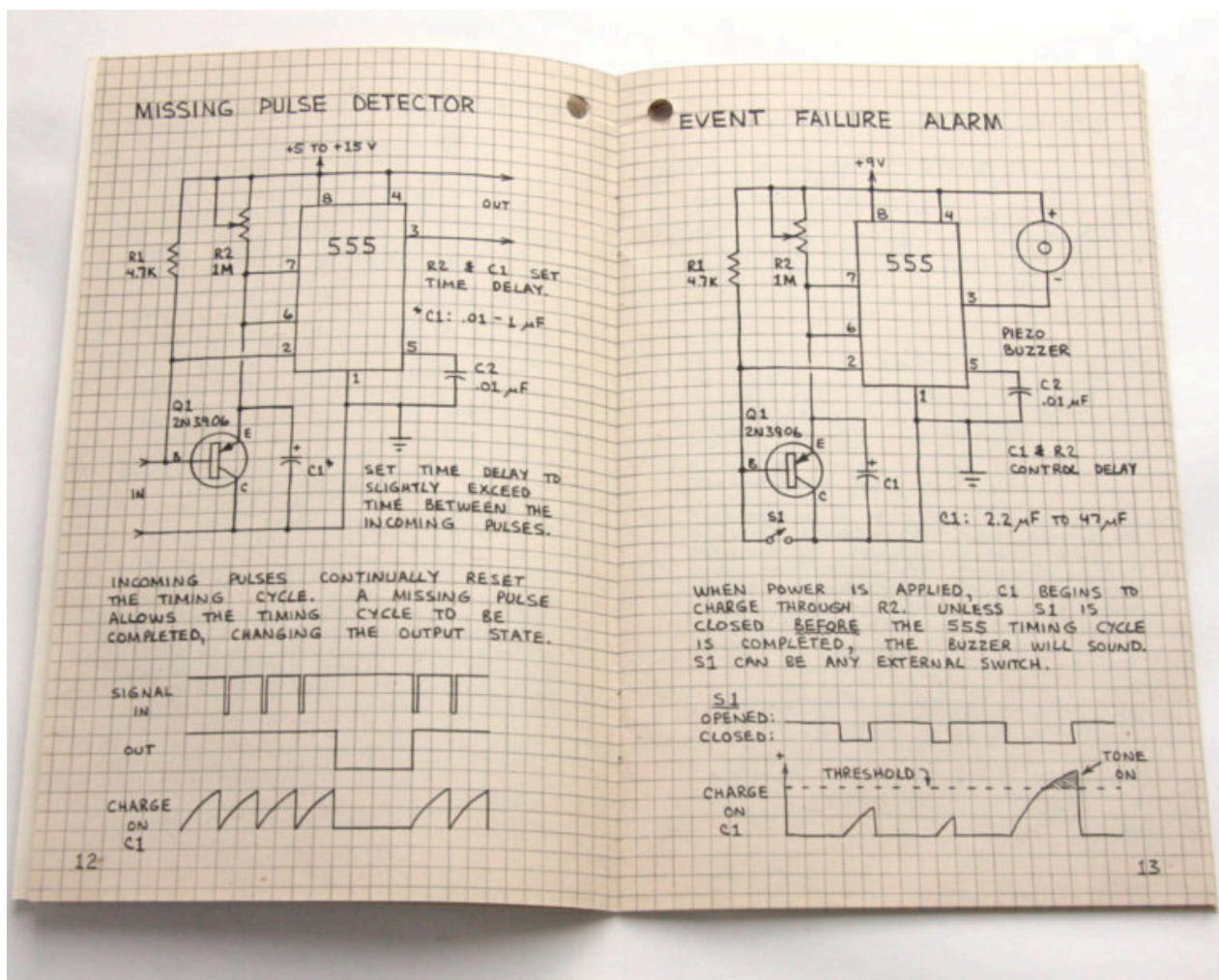
This site "Science Hobbyist", should be your first stop if you want to begin cobbling up devices, and making interesting stuff. For starters, I would suggest this section on [projects](#) to start a project or two that you might be interested in. You can go [HERE](#) to find out some projects for practical jokes. You can go [HERE](#) for some really strange projects (after all that's what Mad Scientists do). This should be a starting point for [Tesla coils](#) and other interests such as lasers and infrared goggles.

[Radio Shack](#)

When I was growing up, Radio Shack was THE place to get parts and supplies for all sorts of cool stuff. In fact, when I was in High School around 1974 through 1977, it was almost the ONLY place where you could get computer parts and accessories. Indeed, around 1977 they cornered the PC market with nearly 100% market share.

Of course, poor management caused that market share to fall like a rock, and the CEO was sacked a few decades later when the market share was under 1%. I wonder why that won't happen to those in charge of the Federal Reserve. Oh, but I digress...

Anyways, Radio Shack has these cool little books and booklets called "The Engineers Notebook", which is sort of a "cookbook" for playing with electronics. You can cobble all kinds of cool things together using the easy to read instructions and diagrams. Want to make a countdown timer for a self-destruct button? Want to make a bug to listen on to what others are saying? Want to make a gadget to shock your friends? All here. Go for it...



The Engineer's Notebook is a great source of information for students, kids, mad scientists, and loony troublemakers. It is well worth the few dollars it costs.

The Art of Electronics

Speaking of electronics, if you are really interested on playing around with electronics, then don't go for a boring text book. Go for a text book that was written by an enthusiast. Read ["The Art of Electronics"](#), and get the LAB book as it is amazing!

"Far and away the finest book on the subject of electronics ... in the last decade. I cannot recommend this book highly enough to anyone whose research or experiments require some electronics."

Optical Engineering

"A delightful book...The circuits actually work, the schematics are all readable."

Review of Scientific Instruments

"This book is filled with a tremendous diversity of valuable information. More importantly, this book is a joy to read...It's not at all like studying--it's too much fun."

EDN (News Edition)

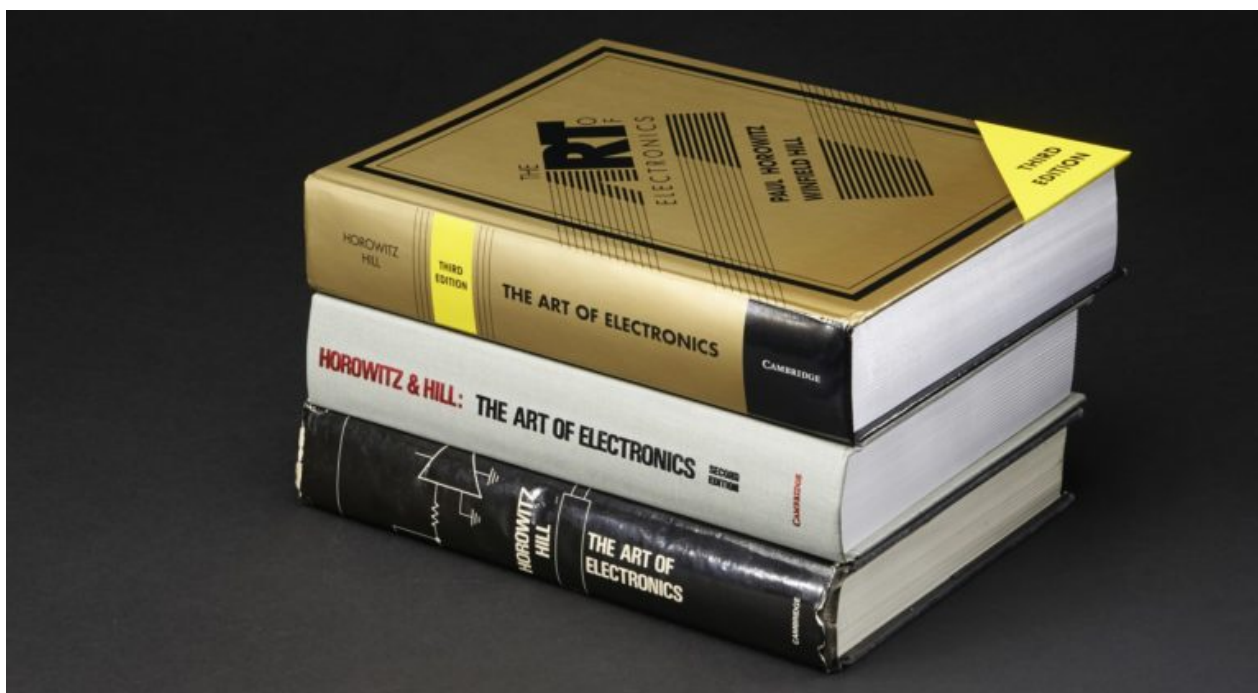
"This book provides a painless way to learn about electronic design. It is also a good read for those already experienced in electronics."

EDN (Magazine Edition)

"...it comes as close as any book we've seen to fulfilling the promise inherent in its title...written as though to educate the novice, but practicing engineers will encounter many useful tidbits they didn't know, hadn't thought about, or had long forgotten."

Analog Dialogue

This book was written as a joy by someone who took a real pleasure in cobbling things together. It is super easy to read, and very interesting to boot. If you have the slightest interest in electronics, you will totally relish this tome.



The Art of Electronics. Here is a stack of the various editions by a fan. Trust me, if you love cobbling things together, then you WILL become a fan.

Websites to DIY Gizmos

In the internet today, it can become pretty daunting if you do not know the correct “buzz words” or Google-approved code words to use in your searches. If you are not careful, you will be sent to websites that are nothing more than [product stores](#) offering cool geeky products, but nothing that would interest a true Mad Scientist.

Well, never fear. Here are some FUN links;

- Make [electronic circuits on paper](#)! And they work!
- [Hack-a-day](#) (I especially like their rail-gun projects.)
- [40 epic cool geeky DIY projects](#)
- [DIY Electronics](#) (Make your own cool geeky stuff from kits.)

Normally, I really do not like many of the websites on the internet. Basically, you have some millennial who constructed a website for profit. They googled similar terms and packaged it in some kind of “hipster” presentation of the day. It’s all packaged nonsense for a profit.

What is missing is HEART. That is to say; websites written by people who LOVE... LOOVVVVEEEEE the subjects that they are writing about. They can go on and on and on about them. Sort of like me and what I like to write about. For instance, [HERE](#) is a website that has some heart. That is different from these *other* websites...

The people who made up these websites don’t eat and drink and love gadgets and gizmos. It’s just a job to them. They are setting up a business model and their plan is to create an income stream off of it. Never the less, they DO have some benefit, if they can help point you in the right direction.

Go visit these two sites, and you will see what I mean...

- [How to get started in DIY electronics projects](#) (Um, worth a a look. Check it out.)
- [Another “how to get started” website](#). It has some promising things here.

Supply Catalogs

There are many places where you can get parts for your inventions. The best place is at companies that specialize in the purchase of excess inventories at factories. You can pick up radar dishes used on military ships, the inner workings of laptops, and all kinds of stuff for a mere fraction of what it costs to make. There are stories galore about these places. One man in Canada used military surplus to open up dimensional doors. Another used the equipment to [build a personal submarine](#). While still another blew up his garage by pressing the wrong button. You got to be careful, don’t ya know.

Electronic Goldmine

This should be your first stop when looking for cheap parts, and orphaned mechanisms to use in your creations. You can find things from cameras used in cell phones to robotic parts here. The only problem is that most of the parts do not come with instructions or schematics. However, a little bit of experimentation and simple observation can help determine what goes where and how. I especial like the “grab bag” of who-know-what that you buy really cheap...



Surprise box of parts from the Electronic Goldmine.

I once took a sensor board used for checking microwave leakage from appliances, it cost me a dollar, and turned it into a bugging sensor. You know, all electronics emit radiation. So, this little device was able to go over a wall or automobile and find out where electronics are. Heh heh. Another time, I took a speaker and turned it into a low frequency generator that I used to attract fleas with. (It was more sanitary than a bug bomb.)

[Surplus Shed](#)

Here is another website that offers surplus stuff. It has a different set of products and some are quite interesting indeed. You can make a pretty impressive telescope from the parts here. They mostly seem to carry things related to optics. This site is very good if you want to fry an ant's nest.

[American Science and Surplus](#)

There are other places on the Internet from which you can order amazing things. May I also suggest another very interesting store, [the American Science and Surplus](#) store. It's most especially good for young boys and girls who have a mad scientist interest. Here are a mixture of [chemistry sets](#), military surplus, industrial surplus, jokes and gizmos, and just plain strange stuff. You can make your own [chewing gum](#). You can [grow crystals](#). You can make all kinds of liquids and [potions that glow](#). You can start on [rock collecting](#), or get started making mechanical gizmos. Explore and have fun.

This would be where you can get toys and gear for your growing children. There are all kinds of scientific goodness here.

[Fair Radio](#)

This website, Fair Radio, is a great source for used military electronics and equipment. It's really not the place to purchase parts to cobble up designs. It is the go-to place to obtain things related to really big projects. I once knew someone who bought the laser rangefinder out of a tank from them. Their stuff can be quite eclectic. With all kinds of things ranging from mine detectors to weather balloons. Never the less, it is worth a look.



There are all kinds of interesting things that you can buy, as long as you know where to go.

I once lived in an apartment in Milford, Massachusetts. It was an old Victorian mansion renovated into six apartments. I really liked the place, the location and the convenience. That was, unfortunately, until a [section eight](#) family moved in and had the entire neighborhood over for all night teenage parties to six in the morning. You know, it's one thing wanting to help out low income people, but it's another thing entirely when your rent is very large (because you work) and your neighbor gets a much larger apartment and pays nearly nothing for it (because they don't).

Ah... Welcome to Massachusetts.

[via GIPHY](#)

For some reason, our new neighbors decided to host teenage parties in the apartment. (I remember knocking on her door at 4:30 am asking them to turn the music down. The woman looked at me in a daze and asked "Oh, you need to work tomorrow?" It was only Monday night, for Pete's sake!) Anyways, teenagers could come over starting at 9pm and play basketball inside the living room. (On the wooden floor, in the firggin' living room.) They would crank up the music to level that made it impossible to think, talk on the phone and sleep. They would do drugs; typically smoke "crack" that would fill up the entire house with smoke. When the parties would get large, over thirty teenagers, the noise would be excessive, and police would come. They would break up the parties. Book the juveniles, and arrest the tenants. The peace and quiet would last one or two days, and then it would repeat. It was a nightmare.

It was really a problem, and the laws in Massachusetts could not do anything about it. My landlord couldn't do anything either. Once they moved in they refused to pay rent, and the State protected them for six months until they could be forcefully evicted. (What a scam, huh? You get someone to take you in. No financial deposit. No first, lasts rent and security deposit. Just a paper from the welfare office. You don't pay rent, and you can't get evicted. It's legislated squatting.) The youth and their instigators were protected. They were starting to break the windows in our vehicles parked outside, and were engaged in all sorts of hyperactive activities that were too rowdy for a quiet neighborhood. I could not sleep. When I would arrive at work, I would be sleep deprived, and terribly irritable. After about two months of sleepless night, I took matters in my own hands. I devised a contraption to put an end to their rock concerts.

I took a furnace igniter from Fair Radio, and placed two long wires in it. Then put the device on a five-minute timer starting at 10:30 at night. (After 10:30 it would turn on and off in five minute intervals.) The result being that I had a device that was an unshielded electric arc generator. I made a [Jacob's Ladder](#). (How to make one can be found [HERE](#).) Being unshielded meant that all their loud electrics would get fried by noise. Thus when they blared their music, after five minutes a horrible howl full of static would assault their ears and blow out their speakers.

The first time it was used was amazing. It was wonderful. W-O-N-D-E-R-F-U-L. There must have been sixty teenagers (60) next door. There couldn't have been anywhere to stand inside. Kids were crapping and urinating outside our bedroom windows, and sitting on all of our cars and vehicles. The music was thumping. It was mostly black urban rap at jet engine noise levels.... It was still early. At 10:30pm, I plugged in the Jacob's Ladder. Turned on the timer and let it rip.

The screeching howl must have permanently damaged the eardrums of each and every teenager. This continued for about thirty seconds. Then it stopped. They turned off the stereo. They mulled about. Talked some. Brought another keg of beer over. Then, they turned on the music again. For five minutes it played on. Then, I hit the “on” button to the gizmo. The howling screeching was horrible.

This continued for about an hour. They would wait. Turn on the stereo. Five minutes later, I would turn on the device. They would shut everything down.... Heh heh. This continued for about two hours and then they broke up and went elsewhere.

Needless to say, they eventually had to find other places to hold their youthful teenage celebrations. Sometimes, when the system fails you, and you need to do something, a creative (and unexpected) solution is always preferred.



You don't mess around with a Mad Scientist. Who knows what creative solutions he may come up with to counter your nefarious activities.

[Herbach & Rademan](#)

This is a great source of supply for motors and generators and all sorts of gears and stuff. I once worked with an electrical engineer in Hattiesburg, Mississippi. He used the electrical motors from here and put them in an old car without the engine. He added some batteries and made a fully electric car. It was pretty darn cool. H&R is a pretty good place for motor controllers, decent low-priced motors and the like.

If I wanted to make a two story tall robot ([Japanese style](#)), or a mechanical metal spider the size of a truck (Russian Style), I would get the parts from this store.

[AllElectronics](#)

AllElectronics is not a surplus store. Rather it is a regular store that sells electronic parts and individual assemblies. It is quite useful for throwing together some prototypes and making things work from scratch. For instance I used the voice module in a prototype for a room air purifier I was working on. When the filter became too dirty, a voice would come on saying "Please change the filter."

You know, we first experimented with a man's voice (one of the techs) but it sounded too ominous. It sounded like Boris the Great was coming to eat you. Then we asked the group secretary to do it, and it sounded hilarious. This was because she had a strong Brooklyn accent.

You can find things like strobe modules, and power strip modules. All would contain instructions and hook up diagrams to help in the installation into your projects. There are also all kinds of project boxes and other kinds of hardware that are quite useful in your mad scientist creations.

Inspiration

As a boy, I was inspired by Ray Bradbury and Robert Heinlein. If you have teenagers, I would suggest you buy them one of both of these two Ray Bradbury books, and let them devour them. They are filled with awe, mystery and excitement. They are works of art that inspires and directs.

- [R is for Rocket](#)
- [S is for Space](#)
- [The Illustrated Man](#)

DREAMERS! BE ENCOURAGED. YOU ARE UNDERSTOOD.

Ray Bradbury's R is for Rocket is a book about and for dreamers... and those who truly desire to understand them. A common character type in his work is the wide-eyed, yearning dreamer who reaches too high, often for a dream beyond his capacity, and who inevitably teeters on the brink of success and failure.

It's no surprise that Bradbury produced so many pieces that gave voice to themes of blue skies since he himself was a dreamer, a voracious reader and enthusiastic writer from an early age, a man who thrilled himself (and his fortunate readers) on the wild imaginings of his literary soul.

In R is for Rocket, the story "The Rocket" is an excellent example of the author's heartfelt kindness and sympathy for – and identification with – the hopes and heartaches of a dreamer, in this case one Fiorello Bodoni, a middle-aged, married-

with-many-children man obsessed with dreams of rocket travel and space exploration in the face of those who are quick to discourage him.

Excerpts from the story:

"I will ride up in one someday," said Bodoni.

"Fool!" cried Bramante. "You'll never go. This is a rich man's world." ... "No! We live in shacks like our ancestors before us."

"Perhaps my sons—" said Bodoni.

"No, nor their sons!" the old man shouted. "It's the rich who have dreams and rockets!" ... "No, Bodoni, buy a new wrecking machine, which you need, and pull your dreams apart with it, and smash them to pieces."

The old man subsided, gazing at the river in which, drowned, images of rockets burned down the sky.

"Good night," said Bodoni.

"Sleep well," said the other.

I have read and loved Ray Bradbury's stories for over forty years because his prose is beautifully delivered and because, as a dreamer myself – who often reaches too high for his own good – I identify deeply with his wonderfully tragic heroes. There were many times that his captivating tales allowed me to escape from grim childhood days and nights, and for that I say to him, now in the Great Beyond for Great Writers: "Thank you!"

This review was written by Kevin Polman, author of THE EXTRA KEY and STORIES.

What you can do...

If you have children, I would strongly advise you let them play.

This does not mean sit them down in a structured environment and teach them how to do some kind of organized activity. I mean set them down with a broken radio, give them a pair of wire cutters and let them go to town. Let them go explore an old abandoned building. Take them to a state park and walk and explore there. Let them know about the Indians who used to live there. Walk them to a junk yard, and let them spend all day at it. Go to a local stream under a bridge, while you take a nap, let the kids play.

Spend time with them. Let them know that it is just fine to go about and throw things together. Give them the resources and then stand back. Give them some room. Let them figure it out on their own. Let them be children without supervision.

Take Aways

- Boys like to build things.
- Boys like to watch the reactions of others when they do something.
- Funneling these interests into fun and innocent activities can be rewarding.
- In the past, boys were free to build and experiment.
- There are avenues to keep this interest alive if you know where to look.
- A thinking person can use their scientific skills to provide answers to pesky problems.

RFH

How about a Request For Help? I tire of busybodies and statists who poke fun at the ideas and theories of others. They offer no constructive dialog. Rather they just make fun, ridicule, and then scurry under a rock.

I use this forum as a way to disseminate some of the things that I learned though my life.

So, if you, the reader, were so interested, I would welcome your stories about the shows and movies that you watched growing up and how they influenced you. I would welcome tales about how you did “experiments” with your chemistry kit, or made electrical devices to pull practical jokes with. I would love to hear about your various adventures.

This is my callout, to you the reader, to assist all of us in solving these mysteries. After all, this is a far better use of the internet than for looking at Justin Bieber videos.

FAQ

Q: Who was Vincent Price?

A: He was an iconic actor who made many famous horror movies in the 1960's and 70's. He greatly influenced culture at the time as his movies were typically B-grade horror flicks, and thus were provided free for children to watch at home.

Q: What is the Mad Scientist Club?

A: It is a series of stories written for children in their pre-teen years. It describes a normal life of a boy in the 1960's. Today the behavior of the boys would be considered criminal, and the DHS might come and arrest the parents.

Q: What is the Man from Uncle?

A: This was a spy vs. spy television show that was popular during the 1960's. It was full of spys and technology and top secrets of the day.

Q: Is it fun to be a mad scientist?

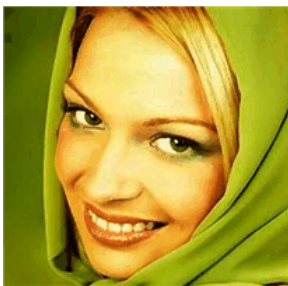
A: It is worth a try. Everyone has a little bit of crazy inside of them. Tools, and a little bit of creativity can create wondrous things, and great pranks.

Q: What does this have to do with MAJestic?

A: This has nothing to do with MAJestic. I am permitted to chat about anything that I am interested in. I like science, gadgets and playing around. So here you are. Perhaps reading this might enable you to get a little into my head. So that you can see that I am just a normal guy (or asshole, if you prefer).

Posts Regarding Life and Contentment

Here are some other similar posts on this venue. If you enjoyed this post, you might like these posts as well. These posts tend to discuss growing up in America. Often, I like to compare my life in America with the society within communist China. As there are some really stark differences between the two.



The Most Important Things That a Man Looks for in a Woman.

Here, we look at the things that men search for in a woman. These things are considered, by men, to be absolutely essential in a mate. We discuss ten attributes and go into detail as to why they are important.



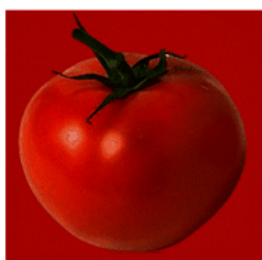
Adventures Exploring the Cemeteries of Indiana

Cemeteries can tell us a lot about ourselves, our history, and our future. This is most especially true in regards to smaller and remote cemeteries located in the counties that surround us. This is my story about the impressions that my forays into these curiosities made upon me.



What it was like being a kid in the early 1970's

This is my narrative of what it was like growing up a a young teenager in 1971. This took place in the hills of Pennsylvania outside of Pittsburgh. I was 13 years old. I went to school, rode my bicycle around everywhere. I fished with my father, and watched television a lot.



The Fiasco of the Reengineering of the Common Tomato

This is the sad, sad story about how the wonderful and tasty tomato was reengineered to be "better". It was made better to ship. Better to sell. Better to store. However, there was one thing missing. No one paid any attention to taste, which is why it tastes like a cardboard shipping box today.



A Movie Tribute to the 1980's When Ronald Reagan Ran America. Here we argue that movies reflect society when they were made. Today we see popular movies being remade as all female versions due to the progressive realities today. Likewise, the movies of the 1980s reflected the time when they were made as well.



Mad Scientist Explorations

Here we discuss what it was like growing up as a boy in the 1960's and the 1970's and the people, things, and adventures that inspired us. As such, we explore how the independence of growing up enabled us to cope through life when we got older.



The Gorilla Cage in the Basement

When I was a small boy, I used to play in the abandoned buildings nearby. Here is a story about one of the objects that lay hidden inside one of those buildings and the possible mysteries that it held. As a child we thought it was a gorilla cage, now as an adult, I am not so sure...



The Importance of a Family Meal Together

There is nothing more important and satisfying than spending time together with friends and family and eating a meal together. It is a time of friendship, familial bonding and relaxation. Here we discuss what I have learned from my childhood and how I apply it today in my life.



The Pleasures of Fresh Baked Bread with Butter

One of the things that I have come to miss, since I moved to China, is fresh hard crusty rolls with full salted butter. The Chinese are not really fans of crusty bread. They like sweets and sponge cakes. Here I describe something that is close to me; not appreciating what you have right in front of you.



What Work was Like in the 1960's and 1970's.

When people go to work today, they find that there are all kinds of rules and regulations. It is for diversity, safety, inclusion, and improvement in a new progressive world. Well, here is what work was like before it became a sterile progressive testing ground for the New World Order.



Learning during my 1970s High School years

Here is a pretty long post on what it was like to go to elementary school in the 1960's, and then attend high school in the 1970's. I graduated in 1977, and that my friend is exactly the target date for the famous movie "Dazed and Confused". Here is the real deal what it was like.



Some True Stories of Cat Heaven

Being in MAJestic taught me many things. One of which was an intimate understanding of Heaven and other "spiritual" things relative to quanta entanglements. Here I discuss what it is like to have a beloved animal (cat) dies and what actually happens to them and why.



Life Lessons from Working within the Corporate Dream – 1

After I was trained by MAJestic, I was left to fend for myself in Corporate America. It was a hellish existence. As such, I learned many lessons concerning behavior and the ultimate impact that it holds on our families, our friends, our loved ones, and our very lives. Here are my commentaries.



Life Lessons from Working within the Corporate Dream – 2

This is part two of the two part section. There is quite a lot of information to impart. Stories are told, and experiences relayed. Honestly working in corporate America in the 1980's, through the new century really sucked. It was harsh on everyone except the owners of the companies.



How to Build Up Your Life from Nothing.

This is for all those young men who are just leaving school and trying hard to build up their life. You can do it. Here are my thoughts and advice for a young man who is encountering that most difficult of challenges; carving your life out in the wilds of the world.



Allow your Children to Play and Grow (Part 1)

I am horrified, just horrified, that parents do not allow their children to play, roam and explore on their own. It has created a society of pampered fearful children. Here I discuss this in terms of what I know. This is very non-PC and might offend the more liberal readers out there.



Allow your Children to Play and Grow (Part 2)

This is the second part of my rant about permitting children to play, explore and have fun. Everyone, the odds that some stranger will abduct your child is very small. Most people who do this are family friends and neighbors. Stop being so fearful. It harms the development of your child.



Ode to Diabolical Cretin John McCain

Well, that evil son-of-a-bitch is finally dead. If his grave wasn't so far away, I go there and dance on top of it. This guy has spent his life backstabbing people, hurting people, concocting wars, and doing everything in his power to disrupt the lives of people. Good fucking riddance.



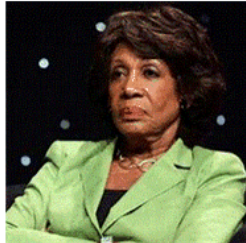
The Song "Baby Got Back" Translated into Latin

Here is a fun post. The song "Baby Got Back" is translated into Latin and then back again. I have to tell you that it is indeed hilarious. *Rebecca, ecce! tantae clunes isti sunt!* (Rebecca, behold! Such large buttocks she has!) Anyways, it's just all fun and games. Enjoy.



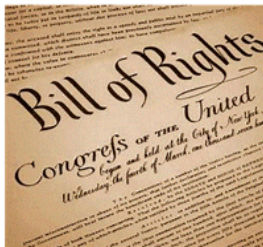
Every Man Should Have a Roll-Top Desk

It's true, and I discuss why. A roll-top desk is made for the person who accumulates the clutter of the road as they forge their way through life. The desk becomes a symbol and a place for a man's privacy. It is a place where he has control over his life, and a place to store his treasures.



What the Progressive Liberals have in store for Conservatives

The progressive socialists, who now go under the name of "Liberals", have plans on the consolidation of their power and control. This is what their ultimate plans are. It does not bode well for traditional American values, Rights, the Constitution, or history. It's going to be a dangerous time.



The Warning Signs that Government Collapse is Imminent

All nations go through cycles. They do so, and when they mature they evolve into other governmental forms. The United States is long overdue for a change; a reset. Now, while this will occur, it is unknown how severe it would be. Here are my thoughts on this issue and some warnings.



Democrat Busybodies and the Destruction of Freedom

Wouldn't life be wonderful if you could just be left alone and live your life in peace? I think so. The founders of the United States thought so, however there is an army of busybodies who disagree. They have this vision of utopia where everyone listens to their commands.



Adventures of a 70's Kid in an Army And Navy Store

Here we look at what adventures an Army and Navy store could hold for the inquisitive child. We talk about the history and the inherent adventures that lay hidden in dusty boxes, and dark corners. We narrate the exploration through the eyes of nostalgia. It's a pleasant excursion.



Comparison between American and Chinese Playgrounds

The differences between American and Chinese playgrounds couldn't be more telling. It is a tale of how things are handled differently and the roles that parents take. In China the role of the parent is to equip the child for life. While in America it is to protect the child from life.



Excuses We Use That Keep Us Enslaved

Here we look at what an American *actually* is. For the argument made here is that citizenship in the United States is not what qualifies a person to be an “American”. Rather it is the way a person thinks, the way they act, and their general philosophy in life. For not everyone is an American.

More Posts about Life

I have broken apart some other posts. They can best be classified about ones actions as they contribute to happiness and life. They are a *little different*, in subtle ways.



On Being an Older Gent

Here are my thoughts on growing old as a man. The truth is that the life that I expected to have as I was growing up never materialized. Instead, something else manifested. My life today is nothing compared to what I thought it would be. For my illusions were created by American media.



Be Who You Are

All our lives we are told who to be, what to do, what career to take. Our religion, our work, our schools, our government, and our loved ones all tell us what we need to do. Here, I tell you the opposite. Stop allowing others to tell you what to do. You know what you need inside of you.



Calexit and the American Civil War

This is a pretty detailed look at the causes of the American civil war, and why it wasn't about slavery. We look at the rewriting of history by the internet, and the efforts that President Obama took to keep California intact so that the Democrats could maintain political power and control.



Why an American man should leave America and Travel

All people should get up off their duff and go forth and Travel. However, this is most especially true for American men. The United States has become a crucible of PC progressive realities that attack and depreciate American men. Go out, young man, see the world as it really is!



The Amazing Bremelanotide PT-141

Forget Viagra, and all those other ED medications. This is the real deal. This little baby causes humans to *go into heat*. It interacts with the brain and sets up feelings of intense arousal on both men and women. It turns people into 16 year olds. As such it is banned in the USA by the FDA.



Bronco Billy and the 25th Law of Power

Bronco Billy is a fictional movie starring Clint Eastwood. The movie depicts the life of a man who decides to change his life and go ahead and do what he has always dreamed of doing. He goes out and becomes his dream. There are lessons here for all of us, we only need listen.



The r/K Selection Theory applied to American Politics

The r/K theory is a pretty well-known theory on animal behavior. It simply states that animals behave as they need to based on the scarcity of resources. Here, we argue that it can be applied to why humans follow different political philosophies. Especially in American politics.



How they get away with it

Ten years ago, Bankers committed fraud in Wall Street that just about devastated the nation. Earlier, we had the S&L fiasco, the nightmare with penny stocks, and now the grand wholesale treason with the selling of Top Secrets to a foreign nation. This is how they get away with it.



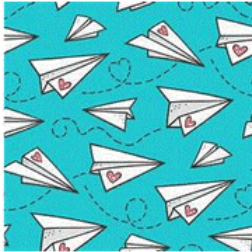
The Line in the Sand – Now What?

It's the same story. Just vote for us, and we will correct everything. Yet, nothing ever happens. You know, boys and girls, this old "song and dance" can only be maintained for so long. Eventually it will fractures, and people will no longer rely on elections to institute change...



The importance of having a second passport.

So President Trump is building a wall to protect Americans. Hum. Where have I heard that before? Oh yes, in Germany right when they were making the wall that separated Berlin. Walls serve two purposes; they keep people out, but they also keep people in. Be careful what you wish for.



How Rocket Scientists Build Paper Airplanes

This is a tale of what me and my classmates used to do when we were young Aerospace Engineering students at the university. We would design paper airplanes and shoot them down with bottle rockets. Here is just a fun little exercise down "memory lane". Enjoy.



What is Snopes.com and can it be Trusted?

Snopes is a "fact check" website that is fully funded by the oligarchy. It is used to "shout down" any narratives that does not support the rich and powerful, and politically connected globally. Here we discuss the organization, who they are and what they represent.



Today America Taxes it's Expats without Representation.

This is a sad state of affairs. Americans who reside outside of the United States now have to pay American taxes, even though they have no representation in Congress. As I recall this was one of the reasons for the American cry for independence in 1776.



What life is like inside the ADC Prison in Arkansas

This post discusses what life is like in a hard labor prison in Southern Arkansas. We discuss hoe squads, food, the hole, commissary, dress, fashion, homosexual culture, prison gangs, murders, relationships and other aspects of life when you are sentenced to "Hard Time".



The Hazing of New Employees – A Lost Tradition

Up until the 1980's all companies would haze new employees. Today, we live in a world regulated by the government and policed by Human Resources. We forget how things used to be just a handful of decades ago. Here is my narrative when I started to work.



How to Build a Gallows and a Hangman's Noose

The United States is entering a period of strife. There will be violence. There will be discord and discomfort. It will be an ugly time. There will be winners and losers. It will be painful for the losers, and the victor will need build a gallows. This is how to do so and why it is needed.



A Wish List of Favorite Firearms

This is a personal list of many favorite firearms that I would like to own. There are various reasons for the particular weapon of choice, and I provide my reasons. This post has no other purpose than to express my desire to own certain weapons that I cannot as an American.



The Ultimate Method to Make Your Computer Safe and Secure

The best way to make your computer secure and private is to have very strong encryption and use an obscure operating system that very few people know about. Here we look at 37 obscure computer operating systems.



Is America a Republic or is it a Democracy – What is it?

Here we take a nice good look at what the United States is today. We look at reports that are suggestive of other governmental organizations. We look at what is going on contemporaneously inside the United States, and we look at how the United States behaves globally.



The Many Things that Democrats want to Ban

This is a running list of the many things that American Democrats want to ban, have banned, or are trying to ban. You know, a ban of anything is a restriction on freedom. That is not what America was founded upon. Yet, here we are today. Everyday is a new ban, and loss of freedom.



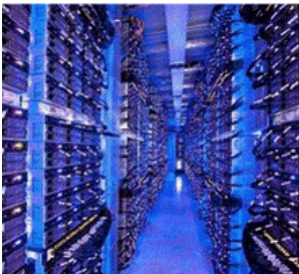
Nations that an American Man could Travel and Relocate to – Part 1

Here, I suggest places where an American man could go if he wanted to start all over again. You know, this happens. Often a man will go through a nasty divorce, or get raked over the coals by a business associate or the United States government. When it happens, it's time to start new.



Nations that an American Man could Travel and Relocate to – Part 2

Here, I suggest places where an American man could go if he wanted to start all over again. You know, this happens. Often a man will go through a nasty divorce, or get raked over the coals by a business associate or the United States government. When it happens, it's time to start new.



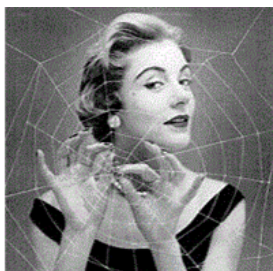
Alternative Search Engines instead of Google

Google does two things that I do not like. Firstly, they vacuum up everything you do and send the information straight to the American deep state; the NSA and DHS. Secondly, they censor your results for you according to what they think you should see. Here we look at alternatives.



The Consequences of the #MeToo Movement

While the #MeToo movement burst forth onto American culture with good intentions, it was soon coopted by those with selfish and sinister intent. The aggressive nature of the accusations, and the consequences of being accused became dangerous. Here we look at the corporate aspect.



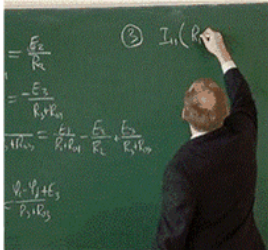
The Lies the Media Tell Us

The United States mainstream media does not report "news". Instead they fabricate events that are designed to manipulate. They do not employ reporters. They employ actors and they stage events for public display. Let's talk about this serious situation and how to avoid manipulation.



What it was like Growing Up in 1960's and 1970's America

Here is my narrative of some stories of what it was like growing up as a kid in the 1960's and the 1970's. It was a time of freedom, and we took full advantage of it. I'll tell you what. I discuss a little about the clothing, friendships, and relationships of that time.



What High School Taught me About Democracy

America was formed as a Republic. Yet, for many decades we were brought up in the notion that the United States is the greatest "Democracy" in the history of the world. I have my own opinions about that. Democracy is "mob rule". Let's talk about it from what I learned in my High School.

Stories that Inspired Me

Here are reprints in full text of stories that inspired me, but that are nearly impossible to find in China. I place them here as sort of a personal library that I can use for inspiration. The reader is welcome to come and enjoy a read or two as well.



Robert Heinlein's "The Long Watch" – Full Text

What if you were in charge of all the nuclear weapons in the world, and your base Commander checks your political leanings to see if you are willing to conduct a coup d'état. What would you do? Would you go along with the opportunity, or would you be a lone hero?



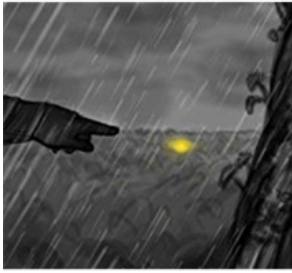
Kaleidoscope (Full Text) A Story by Ray Bradbury

This is the full text of a short story by Ray Bradbury. It concerns the final moments of a crew of spacemen as they drift about in space helplessly after their space rocket explodes. They know that no one can help them as they await their final moments tumbling through space...



Here There Be Tygers by Ray Bradberry

When I was younger I used to read science fiction stories for pleasure. They filled my minds with adventure and passion. One of my favorite authors was Ray Bradberry and here is a complete reprint of one of the stories that has influenced me to be the man that I am today. Enjoy.



The Long Rain (Full Text) by Ray Bradberry

This is the full text of a most excellent science fiction story. It concerns a group of survivors from a crashed spaceship stranded on a Hellish rainy planet; the tropical cloud-covered Venus. They survive the crash, but have to battle the forces of nature and their own passions.



The Fog Horn (Full Text) by Ray Bradberry

Here is a story about the emotions of being the last of your kind. This story is one that influenced me when I was a young boy in the 1970's and continues to haunt me to this day. All of us are human. We all feel emotions and passions. They drive us to accomplish or destroy. It's our choice.



The Rocket (Full Text) A Story by Ray Bradberry

This is a nice short story about a poor man who dreamed about flying into space. No matter how hard he worked, and no matter how much he saved, he was never able to provide for that dream. Then one day, when he was asked to scrap a test rocket, a thought came to mind...



Dark They Were and Golden Eyed (Full Text) by Ray Bradberry

This is the complete short story by Ray Bradberry. It is a story about change and adaptation. I first read this story in my teens and it influenced me to live the life that I am currently living. It is a great read.



A Sound of Thunder (Full Text) A Story by Ray Bradbury

This is the full text of the great time-travel story by Ray Bradbury. Here, a time-travel machine is used to send people back in time to shoot a dinosaur. However, something goes wrong. What would you do? It's a classic story and well worth a read again.



The April Witch (Full Text) by Ray Bradbury

This is a story written by Ray Bradbury that describes what might happen when a young teenaged girl has the power to enter the body of another person. What if, forbidden to experience love and relationships with “normal” people, she uses magic to experience forbidden pleasures...

Articles & Links

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Notes

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